Northwind Labs Employee Handbook: Working hours and remote work

Northwind Labs core hours are 10:00 to 16:00 IST. Outside core hours, employees may organise their day freely as long as agreed deadlines are met.

Employees may work remotely up to 3 days per week. Employees in their first 90 days (the probation period) must work on-site 5 days per week so they can be onboarded properly.

New joiners receive a one-time home-office stipend of Rs 15,000 for a desk and chair. Northwind also reimburses internet costs up to Rs 1,000 per month on submission of the bill.

Team leads may approve a temporary extra remote day for medical or family reasons. Such exceptions are recorded by HR and do not change the standard remote work limit.

Employees working from a different city for more than 2 weeks must inform HR in advance because tax and insurance rules can change with the work location.

Meeting-free Wednesdays are encouraged so that people can do focused work. Recurring meetings should have an agenda circulated at least one day before.

Northwind Labs Employee Handbook: Leave policy

Every employee gets 24 days of paid annual leave per calendar year. Up to 10 unused days can be carried over to the next year; the rest lapse on 31 March.

Sick leave is 12 days per year. A medical certificate is required when sick leave lasts more than 2 consecutive days. There is no certificate requirement for one or two days.

Maternity leave is 26 weeks and paternity leave is 2 weeks. Northwind observes 14 public holidays each year; the list is published every January on the intranet.

Bereavement leave is 5 days for the loss of an immediate family member. Unpaid leave of up to 30 days can be taken once per year with written approval from the manager.

Employees who work on a public holiday at the company's request receive a compensatory day off, which must be used within 60 days of the holiday worked.

Leave requests of 5 or more consecutive days should be submitted at least 2 weeks ahead so that project handovers can be planned.

Northwind Labs Employee Handbook: Expenses and travel

During business travel, employees receive a meal allowance of Rs 1,500 per day. Flights shorter than 6 hours must be booked in economy class.

All expense claims must be filed within 30 days of the expense, with original receipts. Any single expense above Rs 10,000 needs approval from both the manager and the finance team.

Laptops are refreshed every 3 years. Damaged equipment should be reported to IT within 2 working days.

Hotel stays are capped at Rs 6,000 per night in metro cities and Rs 4,000 elsewhere. Employees who find a cheaper option may keep no part of the difference.

Local travel by cab is reimbursed for client visits only. Daily commuting to the office is not reimbursed under any circumstances.

Advance payments for travel can be requested up to 80 percent of the estimated cost and must be settled within 15 days of returning.

Northwind Labs Employee Handbook: Security, learning and exits

Passwords must be at least 14 characters long and multi-factor authentication is mandatory on every company account. Personal USB drives must not be connected to company laptops.

Any suspected security incident must be reported within 24 hours to security@northwindlabs.example. Late reporting is treated as a policy violation.

Each employee has a learning budget of Rs 40,000 per year for courses and certifications. The notice period for resignation is 60 days for all employees.

Performance reviews happen twice a year, in April and October. Each review produces a rating from 1 to 5 that is discussed with the employee in a one-to-one meeting.

Access to production systems is reviewed every quarter. Access that has not been used in 90 days is removed automatically and must be requested again.

On the last working day, employees return all equipment and complete an exit interview with HR. Final settlement is processed within 45 days of the last working day.